

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 19

Asma' ul Mawsulah as Muftada

1. The categories of Ma'rifah that can serve as Muftada

The *Ism ul Mawsul* is one of the categories of the *Ism Ma'rifah*. The categories of *Ma'rifah* that have so far been used as the *Muftada* in a *Jumla Ismiyyah* are set out below — and the *Asma' ul Mawsulah* are now added to them.

Category	Example
Ism ul 'Alam as Muftada	رَيْدٌ صَالِحٌ
Mu'arraf bil Lam as Muftada	الْوَلَدُ صَالِحٌ
Ism ul Isharah as Muftada	هَذَا صَالِحٌ
Ism ud Dameer as Muftada	هُوَ صَالِحٌ
Ism ul Mawsul as Muftada	الَّذِي (هُوَ جَالِسٌ) صَالِحٌ

2. Introduction to the Asma' ul Mawsulah

The *Asma' ul Mawsulah* are also a kind of *Ism*. The word *الَّذِي* is a well-known and commonly used word which every reader recognises easily; it occurs again and again in the Qur'an.

Three opening examples from the Qur'an

- صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ (Surah al-Fatihah: 7)
- الَّذِينَ يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْغَيْبِ وَيُقِيمُونَ الصَّلَاةَ (Surah al-Baqarah: 3)
- إِنَّ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا سَوَاءٌ عَلَيْهِمْ (Surah al-Baqarah: 6)

The meaning of an Ism ul Mawsul

The *Asma' ul Mawsulah* carry the senses of "the one who", "whoever", "whatever", "whom", "whose", "which" and the like.

A distinctive feature of Arabic is the settled existence of the dual. Since the *Asma' ul Mawsulah* are nouns too, all three degrees are found in them as well: singular, dual and plural.

3. The table of the Asma' ul Mawsulah

For recognising and classifying any noun the CNGS Test is applied to it — Capacity (*wus'at*), Number (*'adad*), Gender (*jins*) and Status (*I'raab*). The *Asma' ul Mawsulah* are understood under the same principle. In respect of *wus'at* they are all *Ma'rifah*.

Jins	Wahid	Tathniyah	Jam'
Mudhakkar	الَّذِي	الَّذَانِ	الَّذِينَ
Mu'annath	الَّتِي	الَّتَانِ	الَّتَيْنِ / اللَّائِي

Their examples in the Qur'an

- مَثَلُهُمْ كَمَثَلِ الَّذِي اسْتَوْقَدَ نَارًا — الَّذِي (Surah al-Baqarah: 17)
- وَالَّذِينَ يَأْتِيْنَهَا مِنْكُمْ فَادُّوْهُمَا — الَّذَانِ (Surah an-Nisa: 16)
- صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ — الَّذِينَ (Surah al-Fatihah: 7)
- فَاتَّقُوا النَّارَ الَّتِي وَقُودُهَا النَّاسُ وَالْحِجَارَةُ — الَّتِي (Surah al-Baqarah: 24)
- مَا بَالُ النَّسُوءِ الَّتِي قَطَّعْنَ أَيْدِيَهُنَّ — اللَّائِي (Surah Yusuf: 50)
- إِنَّ أَمَّهُتُهُمْ إِلَّا الَّتِي وَلَدْنَهُمْ — اللَّائِي (Surah al-Mujadilah: 2)

4. The difference between Rasm 'Uthmani and ordinary Arabic

In the writing of the *Asma' ul Mawsulah* a difference is found between the script of the Qur'an and that of ordinary — that is, standard written — Arabic.

In ordinary Arabic	Which nouns
written with one lam	الَّذِي ، الَّذِينَ ، الَّتِي
written with two lams	الَّذَانِ ، الَّتَانِ ، اللَّائِي ، اللَّائِي

The script of the Qur'an: In the Qur'an all the *Asma' ul Mawsulah* are written with a single lam. This script of the Qur'an is called the *Rasm 'Uthmani* or *Rasm ul Mushaf*, in which the spelling of many words differs from ordinary Arabic.

5. The hamzah of the Asma' ul Mawsulah

Rule: The hamzah written in all the Arabic *Asma' ul Mawsulah* is a *Hamzat ul Wasl*, not a *Hamzat ul Qat'*. That is, in *الَّذِي* ، *الَّذَانِ* ، *الَّتِي* ، *الَّذِينَ* ، *الَّذِي* the hamzah at the beginning of each is a *Hamzat ul Wasl*.

- If they come at the beginning of speech, the hamzah is pronounced.
- If they come in the middle of a sentence they are joined to what precedes, and the hamzah is not pronounced.

Examples of this from the Qur'an:

- *مَثَلُهُمْ كَمَثَلِ الَّذِي اسْتَوْفَدَ نَارًا* (Surah al-Baqarah: 17)
- *وَالَّذِينَ يَأْتِيْنَهَا مِنْكُمْ فَادُّوهُمْ* (Surah an-Nisa: 16)
- *صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ* (Surah al-Fatihah: 7)

6. The Silat ul Mawsul

An *Ism ul Mawsul* is a noun whose full meaning is not understood until some clause is joined to it.

Definition: The clause coming after an *Ism ul Mawsul* by which the meaning is completed is called the *Silat ul Mawsul*. This *silah* states the explanation, the specification and the description of that *Ism ul Mawsul*. Together, the *Ism ul Mawsul* and its *Silat ul Mawsul* play some part in the sentence, that is, they become a component of it.

The most important point: The *Asma' ul Mawsulah* never come alone. In more than ninety-nine percent of cases a *Jumla Fi'liyyah* comes with them, though a *Jumla Ismiyyah* may come as well.

The pronoun in the Silah is obligatory

The governing principle: The *Silat ul Mawsul* must contain a pronoun which agrees with the *Ism ul Mawsul* in number and gender. This is a foundational principle of Arabic *Nahw*. If that pronoun is absent, the *Silat ul Mawsul* is not complete and cannot be used with the *Ism ul Mawsul*.

Ism ul Mawsul	Which pronoun is obligatory in the Silah
الَّذِي — singular masculine	a singular masculine pronoun
الَّذَانِ — dual masculine	a dual masculine pronoun
الَّذِينَ — plural masculine	a plural masculine pronoun
الَّتِي — singular feminine	a singular feminine pronoun

Ism ul Mawsul	Which pronoun is obligatory in the Silah
الَّتَانِ — dual feminine	a dual feminine pronoun
الَّلَائِي — plural feminine	a plural feminine pronoun

7. The Ism ul Mawsul as Muftada — how it is built

The basic construction: *Ism ul Mawsul* + *Silat ul Mawsul* = *Muftada*. After that the *Khabar* is brought, and so a complete *Jumla Ismiyyah* is formed.

Take the word الَّذِي. Its *silah* is هُوَ جَالِسٌ, which is itself a complete *Jumla Ismiyyah*: in it هُوَ is the *Muftada* and جَالِسٌ the *Khabar*. This *Muftada* joins its *Khabar* to form a *Jumla Ismiyyah*, and that in turn becomes the *Silat ul Mawsul*. The pronoun هُوَ present in the *silah* agrees exactly with الَّذِي in number and gender.

الَّذِي (هُوَ جَالِسٌ) صَالِحٌ

Muftada → (Silat ul Mawsul) → Khabar

Translation: the one who is seated is righteous.

The purpose of the brackets: The *Silat ul Mawsul* is written in brackets so that it stays clear that this whole clause is the explanation of the *mawsul* and not its *Khabar*. The *Khabar* is the word that comes after the closing bracket.

8. Complete examples of the six Asma' ul Mawsulah

The table below sets out all six *Asma' ul Mawsulah* on one and the same construction, so that the principle of agreement becomes plain.

Ism ul Mawsul	Silat ul Mawsul	Khabar	The complete sentence
الَّذِي	هُوَ جَالِسٌ	صَالِحٌ	الَّذِي (هُوَ جَالِسٌ) صَالِحٌ
الَّذَانِ	هُمَا جَالِسَانِ	صَالِحَانِ	الَّذَانِ (هُمَا جَالِسَانِ) صَالِحَانِ
الَّذِينَ	هُمْ جَالِسُونَ	صَالِحُونَ	الَّذِينَ (هُمْ جَالِسُونَ) صَالِحُونَ
الَّتِي	هِيَ جَالِيسَةٌ	صَالِحَةٌ	الَّتِي (هِيَ جَالِيسَةٌ) صَالِحَةٌ
الَّتَانِ	هُمَا جَالِيسَتَانِ	صَالِحَتَانِ	الَّتَانِ (هُمَا جَالِيسَتَانِ) صَالِحَتَانِ
الَّلَائِي	هُنَّ جَالِيسَاتُ	صَالِحَاتُ	الَّلَائِي (هُنَّ جَالِيسَاتُ) صَالِحَاتُ

- First row: the one who is seated is righteous.
- Second row: the two who are seated are righteous.
- Third row: those who are seated are righteous.
- Fourth row: she who is seated is righteous.
- Fifth row: the two women who are seated are righteous.
- Sixth row: the women who are seated are righteous.

A second drill with the word Dahik

Ism ul Mawsul	Silat ul Mawsul	Khabar	The complete sentence
الَّذِي	هُوَ ضَاحِكٌ	صَادِقٌ	الَّذِي (هُوَ ضَاحِكٌ) صَادِقٌ
الَّذَانِ	هُمَا ضَاحِكَانِ	صَادِقَانِ	الَّذَانِ (هُمَا ضَاحِكَانِ) صَادِقَانِ
الَّذِينَ	هُمْ ضَاحِكُونَ	صَادِقُونَ	الَّذِينَ (هُمْ ضَاحِكُونَ) صَادِقُونَ
الَّتِي	هِيَ ضَاحِكَةٌ	صَادِقَةٌ	الَّتِي (هِيَ ضَاحِكَةٌ) صَادِقَةٌ
الَّتَانِ	هُمَا ضَاحِكَتَانِ	صَادِقَتَانِ	الَّتَانِ (هُمَا ضَاحِكَتَانِ) صَادِقَتَانِ
الَّتِي	هُنَّ ضَاحِكَاتُ	صَادِقَاتُ	الَّتِي (هُنَّ ضَاحِكَاتُ) صَادِقَاتُ

First row: the one who is laughing is truthful. And the last: the women who are laughing are truthful.

9. The Asma' ul Mawsulah and I'raab

Rule: The singular and plural *Asma' ul Mawsulah* are *Mabni*, that is, they do not change — their form stays one and the same in all three states of *raf'*, *nasb* and *jarr*. Only the *dual Asma' ul Mawsulah* are *Mu'rab* and change on account of *I'raab*.

Jins	Wahid	Tathniyah — raf'	Tathniyah — nasb & jarr	Jam'
Mudhakkar	الَّذِي	الَّذَانِ	الَّذَيْنِ	الَّذِينَ
Mu'annath	الَّتِي	الَّتَانِ	الَّتَيْنِ	الَّتِي / اللَّائِي

I'raab Mahalli

Since the singular and plural *Asma' ul Mawsulah* are *Mabni*, their form never changes. In the reckoning of the grammarians the *I'raab* of a *Mabni* noun is *mahallan*, that is, by position. So if a *Mabni* noun stands in a place where a *Majroor* would be expected, it is said that this noun is here *mahallan Majroor*.

10. Analysis of the Qur'anic verses

10.1 Surah al-Fatihah

صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ

(Surah al-Fatihah: 7)

Translation: The path of those upon whom You have bestowed favour.

- Here الَّذِينَ is the plural masculine *Ism ul Mawsul*.
- After it comes its *Silat ul Mawsul*: أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ, which is a complete *Jumla Fi'liyyah*. The pronoun هُمْ in the *silah* is plural masculine, exactly matching the *Ism ul Mawsul*.
- Being a *Hamzat ul Wasl*, it is joined to what precedes and read صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ; the hamzah is not pronounced.
- الَّذِينَ is here *mahallan Majroor*, because it stands in the place of a *Mudaf Ilayh*, though being *Mabni* its form has not changed.

10.2 Surah al-Baqarah verse 3 — two possible readings

الَّذِينَ يُؤْمِنُونَ بِالْغَيْبِ وَيُقِيمُونَ الصَّلَاةَ وَمِمَّا رَزَقْنَاهُمْ يُنْفِقُونَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 3)

Translation: Those who believe in the unseen, and establish the prayer, and spend out of what We have provided them.

In this verse the *I'raab* of الَّذِينَ can be settled in two ways.

- If it is taken together with the closing part of the previous verse, هُدًى لِّلْمُتَّقِينَ, then it comes as a description of الْمُتَّقِينَ, and is therefore *mahallan Majroor*.
- And if it is taken as a fresh statement, a new beginning, then الَّذِينَ together with its *silah* becomes the *Mubtada*, and is therefore *mahallan Marfoo'*.

In both cases the form of the word stays the same; only the *I'raab Mahalli* differs.

10.3 Surah al-Baqarah verse 6

إِنَّ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا سَوَاءٌ عَلَيْهِمْ ءَأَنذَرْتَهُمْ أَمْ لَمْ تُنذِرْهُمْ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 6)

Translation: Indeed those who disbelieve — it is all the same to them whether you warn them or do not warn them; they will not believe.

Here the *Ism ul Mawsul* الَّذِينَ has been used in the place of a *Mansoob*, since it is the *ism* of إِنَّ. It is therefore *mahallan Mansoob*.

The lesson of these three verses: The single word **الَّذِينَ** is written in exactly the same form in all three verses, yet its *l'raab Mahalli* differs in each place — *Majroor* in one, *Marfoo'* in another and *Mansoob* in the third. This is the very mark of a *Mabni* noun.

Summary

1. The Ism ul Mawsul is one of the categories of the Ism Ma'rifah, and like the other categories it too can serve as the Mubtada.
2. The Asma' ul Mawsulah carry the senses of "the one who", "whoever", "whom", "whose" and the like.
3. Since the Asma' ul Mawsulah are nouns, all three degrees are found in them: singular, dual and plural.
4. The masculine Asma' ul Mawsulah are: الَّذَانِ, الَّذِي, and الَّذَيْنِ.
5. The feminine Asma' ul Mawsulah are: اللَّتَانِ, الَّتِي, and اللَّائِي or اللَّائِي.
6. In ordinary Arabic three of them are written with one lam and four with two lams, but in the Qur'an all are written with a single lam.
7. This script of the Qur'an is called the Rasm 'Uthmani or Rasm ul Mushaf.
8. The hamzah of all the Asma' ul Mawsulah is a Hamzat ul Wasl, not a Hamzat ul Qat'.
9. At the beginning of speech this hamzah is pronounced; joined to what precedes in mid-sentence, it is not.
10. The clause after an Ism ul Mawsul by which the meaning is completed is called the Silat ul Mawsul.
11. The Asma' ul Mawsulah never come alone; in more than ninety-nine percent of cases a Jumla Fi'liyyah comes with them.
12. The Silat ul Mawsul must contain a pronoun agreeing with the Ism ul Mawsul in number and gender.
13. If that pronoun is absent, the Silat ul Mawsul is not complete and cannot be used with the Ism ul Mawsul.
14. The basic construction is: Ism ul Mawsul + Silat ul Mawsul = Mubtada, after which the Khabar comes.
15. The Silat ul Mawsul is written in brackets so that it stays clear it is the explanation of the mawsul and not its Khabar.
16. The singular and plural Asma' ul Mawsulah are Mabni, keeping one and the same form in all three states.
17. Only the dual Asma' ul Mawsulah are Mu'rab: الَّذَانِ and اللَّتَانِ in raf', and الَّذَيْنِ and اللَّائِي in nasb and jarr.
18. The I'raab of a Mabni noun is mahallan, that is, by position.
19. In Surah al-Fatihah الَّذِي is mahallan Majroor; in Surah al-Baqarah verse 3 it is either mahallan Majroor or mahallan Marfoo'; and in verse 6 it is mahallan Mansoob.

Exercise

1. Write the five categories of Ma'rifah that can serve as the Mubtada, each with an example.
2. Write the meanings of the Asma' ul Mawsulah and set out all three masculine and all three feminine forms.

3. Explain the difference between ordinary Arabic and the Rasm 'Uthmani in writing the Asma' ul Mawsulah.
4. Which hamzah do the Asma' ul Mawsulah carry? Explain both of its rulings with examples.
5. Define the Silat ul Mawsul and state what work it does.
6. What is the ruling concerning the pronoun in the Silat ul Mawsul, and what follows if it is absent?
7. Write the basic construction by which an Ism ul Mawsul becomes the Muftada.
8. Why is the Silat ul Mawsul written in brackets?
9. Form complete sentences with all six Asma' ul Mawsulah, adding a silah and a Khabar to each.
10. Using the word Dahik as the silah, write sentences for all three masculine forms.
11. Which Asma' ul Mawsulah are Mabni and which are Mu'rab? Write both states of the dual.
12. What is meant by l'raab Mahalli?
13. State the silah of الَّذِينَ in Surah al-Fatihah verse 7 and give its l'raab Mahalli.
14. What are the two possible readings of الَّذِينَ in Surah al-Baqarah verse 3, and why?
15. What is the l'raab Mahalli of الَّذِينَ in Surah al-Baqarah verse 6, and what is the reason for it?

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ